

Erik Drouhard

DESIGNER & ENGINEER

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SUMMARY

Designer and engineer who makes complex software easier to understand and use. Combines interaction design, front-end engineering, rapid prototyping, and design systems to help teams evaluate product behavior, make informed decisions, and build consistent experiences.

Core Skills: AI Design Engineering, Human-Agent Interaction, Agentic UX, Rapid Prototyping, Design Systems, Interaction Design, Conversational and Multimodal Interfaces, Complex Systems UX, Behavior Authoring, Cross-Functional Leadership, Accessibility, Usability Testing, Context Engineering

Tools: Figma, Paper.design, Framer, HTML/CSS/SCSS, JavaScript/TypeScript, React, Next.js, Python, Git/GitHub

AI & Agent Tooling: Claude Code, OpenAI Codex, GitHub Copilot CLI, OpenCode, pi, agentic coding workflows, spec-driven development, LLM-assisted prototyping and evaluation

EXPERIENCE

Microsoft

June 2017 - September 2026

Joined Nuance Communications in June 2017; became a Microsoft employee through the March 2022 acquisition and moved into the Copilot Studio org in August 2023.

UX Engineer II, CoreAI

March 2025 - September 2026

- Co-led prototyping and tooling for Microsoft Foundry and Azure portals, helping a 10-person team within a 30+ person design organization explore AI product behavior through working mini-apps, reusable agent skills, and shared workflows.
- Reduced prototype turnaround from weeks to hours, letting teams explore, test, and validate directions before committing engineering resources.
- Equipped the immediate team and broader design organization to use AI-assisted development through reusable skills, shared workflows, weekly learning sessions, and hands-on guidance.

Product Designer II, Copilot Studio

August 2023 - March 2025

- Designed and prototyped authoring interfaces in Copilot Studio, partnering with design and engineering to help users build and customize complex conversational AI workflows.
- Planned and facilitated a 3-day stakeholder sprint that turned behavior-authoring requirements into priorities for nested conditions and aligned the group on the capabilities to pursue.
- Promoted from Product Designer I to Product Designer II.

Senior UX Engineer, Verse Design System · Nuance Communications

November 2022 - August 2023

- Led design and front-end architecture for Verse, giving teams a shared foundation for Mix, Nuance's voice IVR and virtual assistant platform. Established accessible React components, interaction patterns, tokens, and implementation practices using Radix and vanilla-extract.
- Coordinated architecture, governance, and adoption planning across multiple engineering and design teams serving Nuance's CoreAI R&D organization; a Verse talk drew 60+ attendees and ranked among the internal conference sessions with the largest attendance.

Senior UX Designer, Mix.dialog · Nuance Communications

February 2019 - November 2022

- Led interaction design in Mix.dialog to make complex conversational behavior easier to author, covering conditions, QA, questions, channels, and modalities for voice IVR and virtual assistants. Work included Sony Interactive Entertainment's PlayStation 5 and close partnership with Rakuten.
- In a longitudinal study with 17 IVR and digital virtual assistant designers, the new condition stack raised CSAT from 5.0 to 7.0 (+40%) and SUS from 52.7 to 61.5; both gains were statistically significant at $p < .05$.
- Made the multi-year case for a platform design system and secured leadership buy-in, then defined token and component architecture with front-end engineering from 2021, work that became Verse.

UI/UX Designer, Dragon Drive, Mix, Swype · Nuance Communications

June 2017 - February 2019

- Led UI and interaction design for a CES 2019 prototype exploring voice-enabled AI in a fully autonomous future. The stationary 220-degree demonstration combined a gaze-enabled windshield HUD, voice, and real-time multimodal feedback.
- The showcase supported work with Daimler (Mercedes-Benz); the wider Dragon Drive platform powered 250M+ cars across 40+ languages before Nuance's automotive business was spun out as Cerence in 2019.

Applause

April 2016 - March 2017

Front-End Developer & Designer

- Led front-end development for Applause.com, a custom WordPress installation with multi-language support, working directly with marketing leadership and partnering with design and international engineering teams.
- Directed a shift to a headless architecture (Contentful, Middleman, Vue) to reduce the legacy CMS's vulnerability exposure and publishing-approval latency; selected and built the stack through to pre-launch before departing.

Cold Spring Design

April 2011 - February 2016

Web Designer

- Led visual design and front-end development for marketing websites using HTML, SCSS, jQuery, and WordPress.

EDUCATION

American International College

Master Certificate, Visual Communications